INVESTOR BRIEFING · JULY 2026

The State of the Verified Startup Economy

How 1,000 payment-verified startups reveal who actually earns, why, and where the next wave of capital should go.

Prepared for the Investment Committee

THE SOURCE OF TRUTH

What This Platform Actually Is

A public database where startups connect their live payment accounts and publish their real, machine-verified revenue — replacing self-reported claims with numbers that update automatically.

1

Payment-Verified, Not Self-Reported

Startups link Stripe, RevenueCat, Paddle and similar providers through a read-only API. Revenue is pulled directly from the payment ledger, not typed into a form.

2

A Public Leaderboard

Every listed company is ranked by verified monthly recurring revenue, turning private financials into a searchable, comparable public record.

3

An Acquisition Marketplace

A subset of companies also list themselves for sale, with asking price and revenue multiple attached to the same verified numbers — collapsing discovery and deal-making into one layer.

Why this matters to investors: it is one of the few places where startup revenue can be trusted at face value — turning this report from opinion into evidence.

MARKET CONTEXT

Understanding the Domain: The Rise of the Solo-Built Startup

A structural shift in software: small, often single-founder companies now build and monetise products that once required a full venture-backed team.

2020

"Build in Public" Emerges

Founders share revenue screenshots on social media to build trust and audience.

2023

The AI Tooling Boom

AI coding assistants cut build time sharply; anyone can ship a working product in weeks.

2025

Verified-Revenue Directories

Platforms begin connecting directly to payment APIs, replacing screenshots with hard data.

2026

Discovery Becomes M&A

Verified databases add acquisition marketplaces — the sector we analyse in this report.

$15.7B → $59.6B

Projected micro-SaaS market size, 2024 to 2030 (~30% CAGR)

~$375B

Estimated total SaaS industry size in 2026

12%

Median growth rate of large SaaS platforms in 2025, down from 30% in 2021 — the gap smaller, focused products are filling

Source: industry market-sizing reports (micro-SaaS & SaaS growth), 2026

The Index at a Glance

A snapshot of every payment-verified startup tracked as of 30 July 2026.

1,000
Startups Tracked

65
Countries Represented

29
Product Categories

$13.5M
Combined Monthly Recurring Revenue

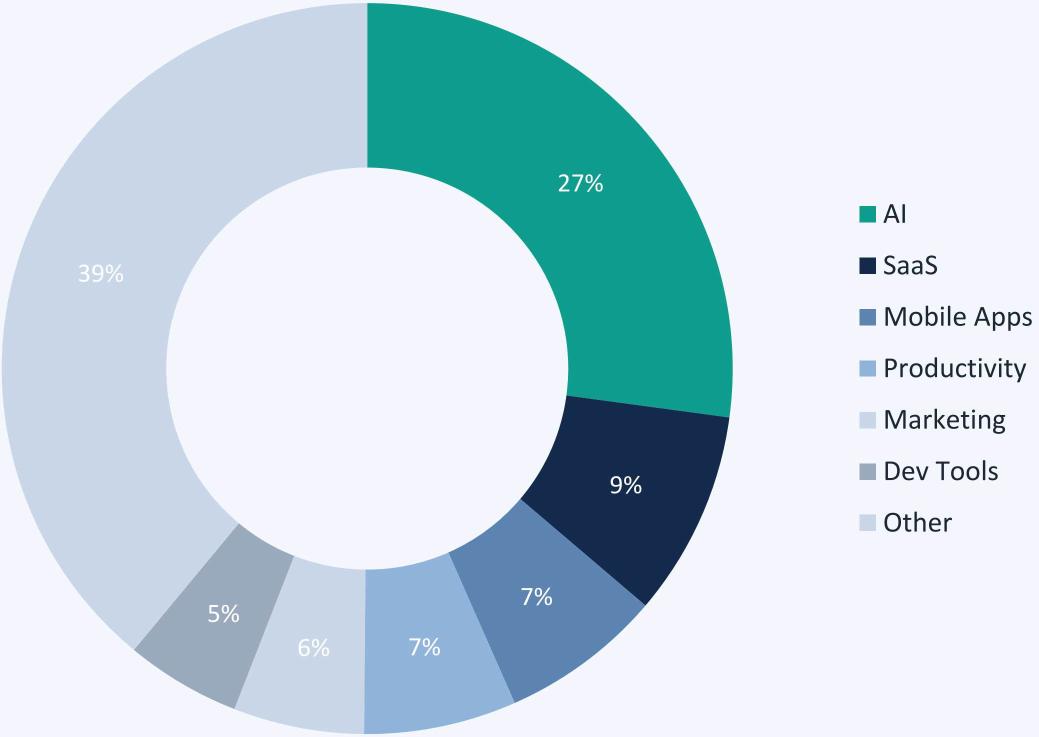
$133.8M
Combined Trailing 12-Month Revenue

500,597
Active Paying Subscriptions

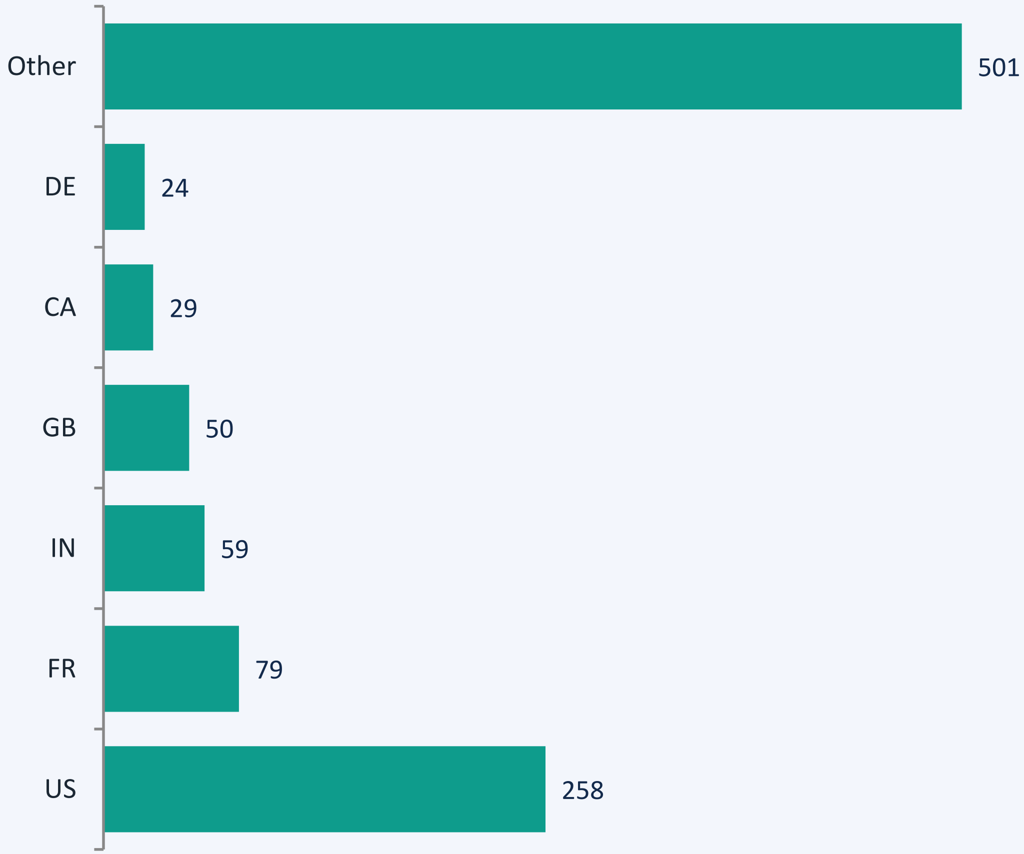
Figures are the sum of individually verified, payment-provider-confirmed revenue across all tracked startups — not estimates.

What They Build, and Where They Build It

Product Category Mix

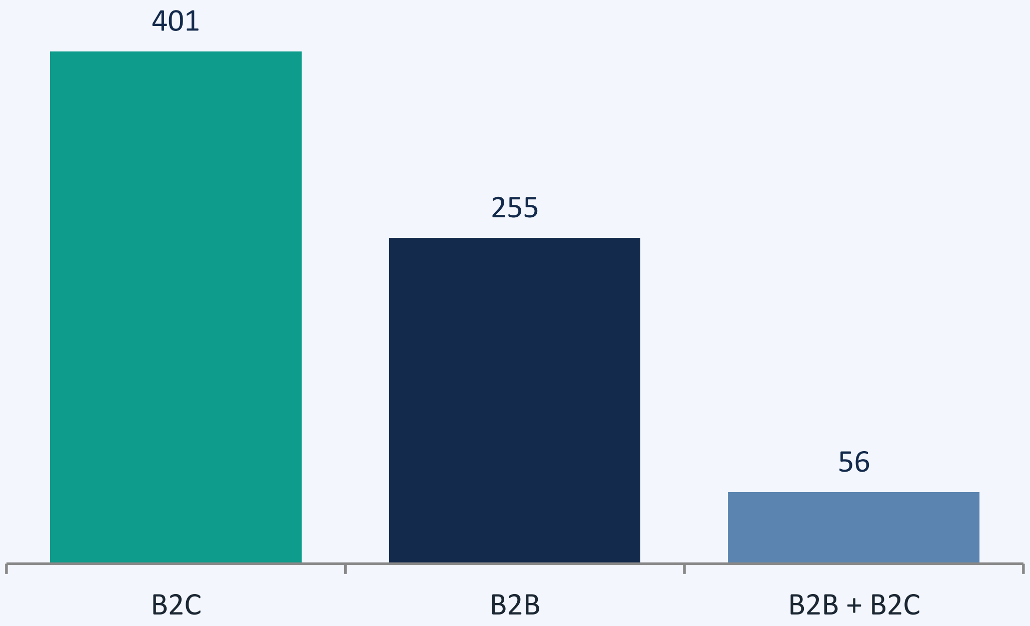


Top Countries by Number of Startups



AI dominates the field almost 3-to-1 over the next largest category. The United States alone hosts more listed startups than the next five countries combined.

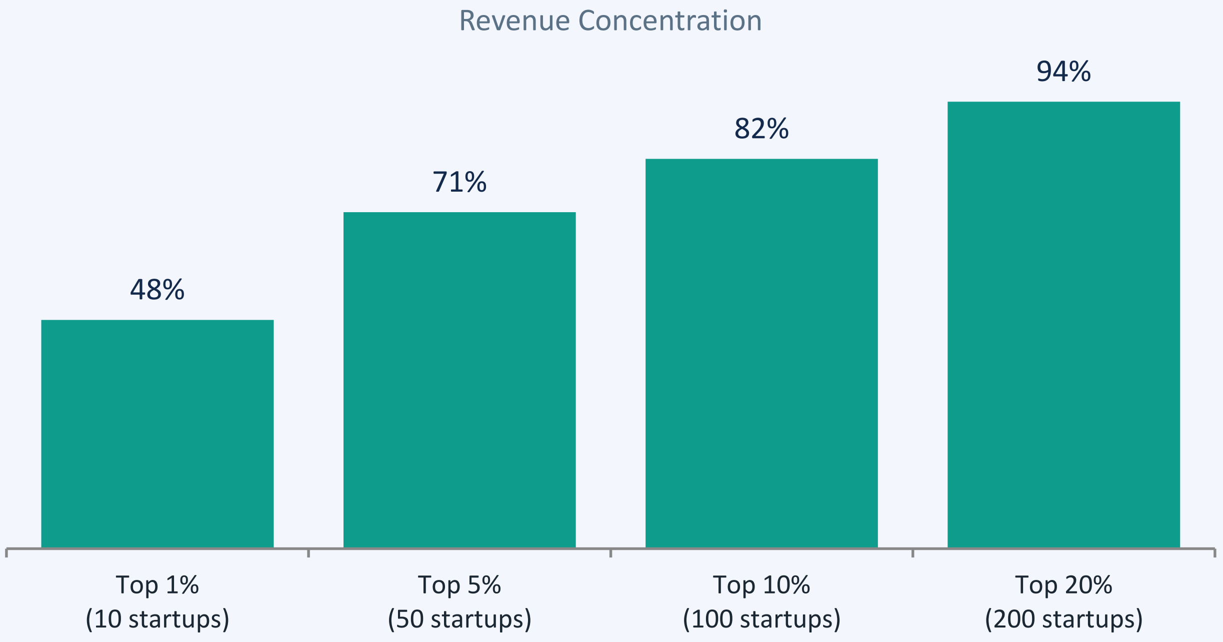
Who's on the Platform



Declared audience type (of profiles that disclose one)

- Consumer-facing (B2C) founders outnumber business-facing (B2B) founders by roughly 3-to-2 — this is still a consumer-product-heavy field.
- About 13% of listings appear as an anonymous “stealth company.” Revenue is still verified through the payment API even when identity is hidden.
- Listing is voluntary and unaudited beyond the payment connection — the index mixes serious ventures with side projects and hobby launches.
- This self-selection matters: it means the field is wide, but not every listed company is a viable standalone investment. The next slides show why that distinction matters.

Who's Actually Making Money



Share of the platform's total monthly recurring revenue captured by its top-earning startups

39.4%

of startups earn under $100/month — hobby-tier, not investable

21.2%

clear $10,000+ monthly — a real, fundable business tier

CAUSE

Near-zero distribution cost lets a few winners capture most attention and revenue.

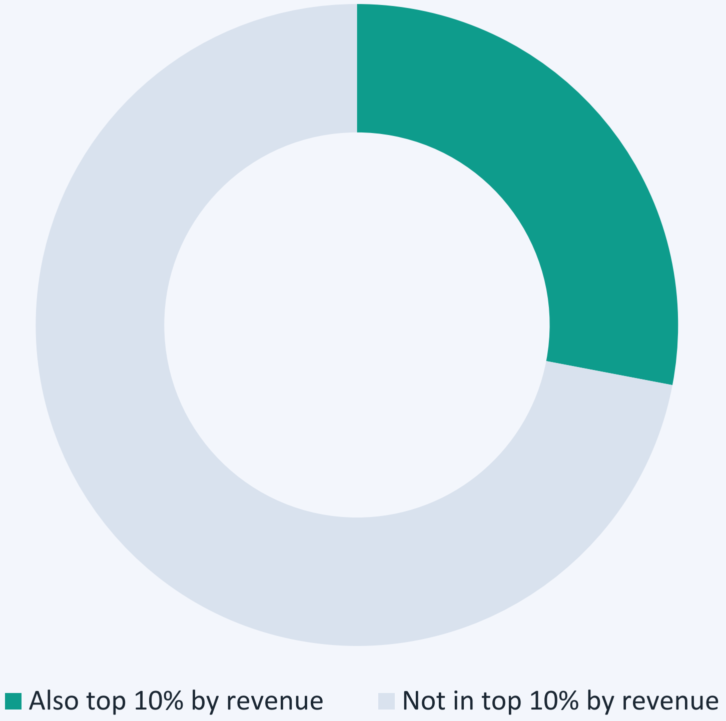
→

EFFECT

Target the top decile of operators, or the infrastructure that serves the whole long tail.

The top 1% of startups (10 companies) alone capture 48% of all revenue on the platform.

Who's Getting the Traffic



Of the 50 most-followed startups on social media

- Typical startup: just 67 followers. The average (~4,070) is skewed by a few viral accounts.
- Only 14 of the 50 most-followed startups also rank in the top 10% by revenue — a 28% overlap.
- A big audience drives attention, not automatically paying customers.

CAUSE

Social reach is cheap to build and easy to see from outside.

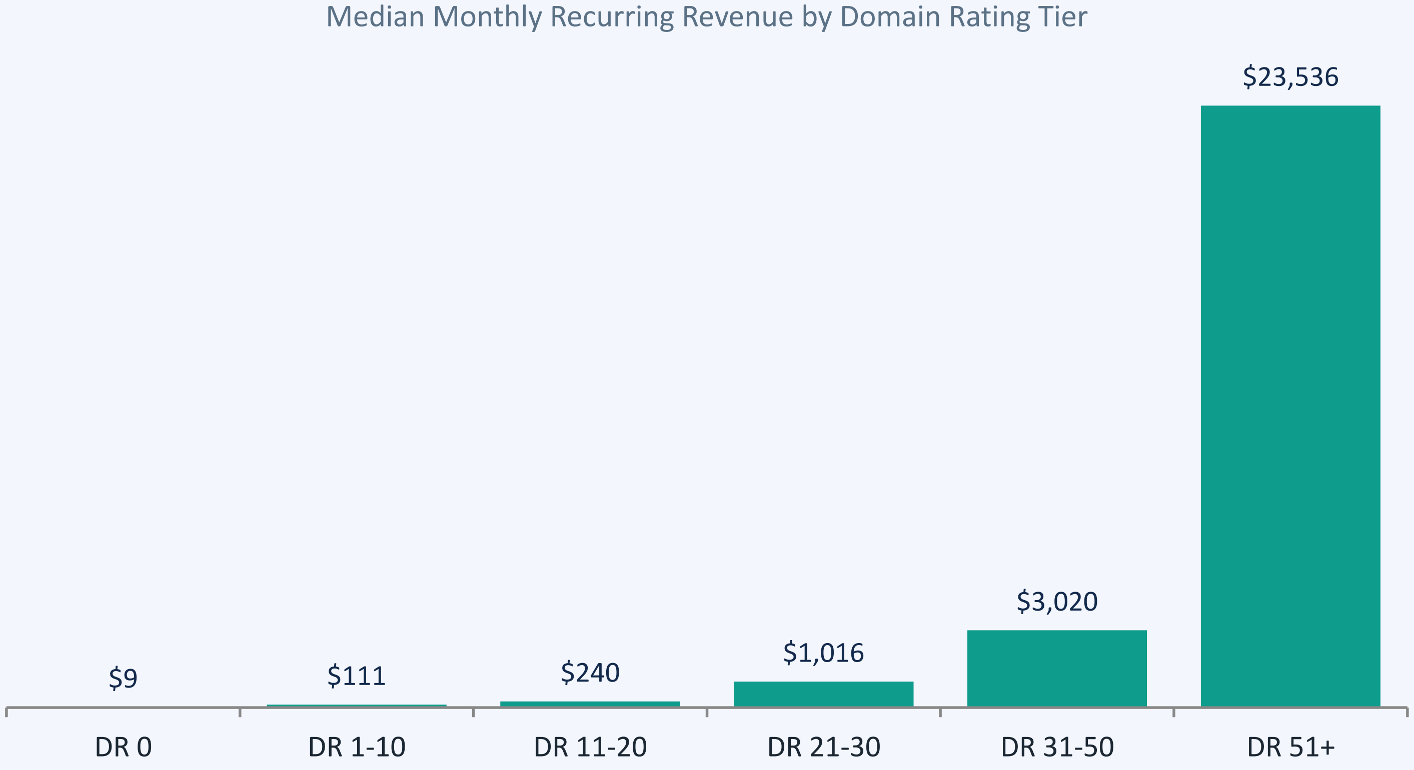
→

EFFECT

Discount follower counts in diligence — weight verified revenue and search authority instead.

Search Authority Drives Revenue

Domain Rating measures a website's search-engine trust and backlink strength (0–100 scale). It is the strongest single predictor of revenue in this data.



2,500x

revenue gap between the lowest and highest authority tiers

r = 0.48

correlation with revenue — stronger than social following (0.18)

CAUSE

Domain authority compounds free organic traffic and lowers acquisition cost.

→

EFFECT

Early SEO investment is a durable moat — a stronger signal than short-term growth.

The Marketplace Layer

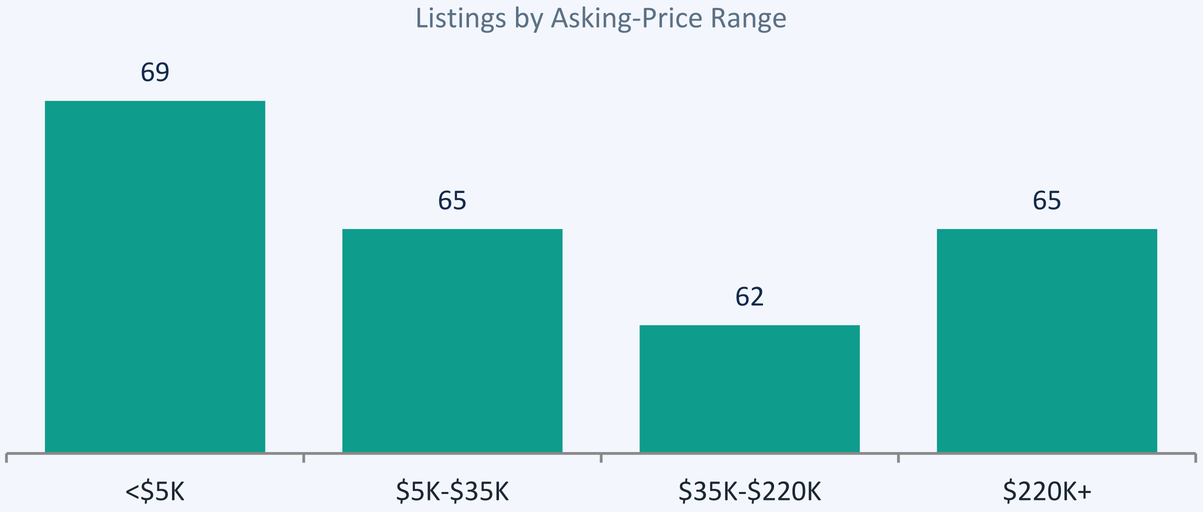
A quarter of listed startups are also for sale on the same platform — turning a discovery index into an active acquisition market.

26.2%
of startups are listed for sale

$35K
median asking price for listings

3x
typical multiple of trailing revenue

$332K
mean price — pulled up by a few large listings



CAUSE

Verified, synced revenue removes the biggest trust barrier in small-business M&A.

EFFECT

Trust speeds up sales, and completed sales attract new buyers back into the index.

CONCLUSION

The Investment Thesis

1

A fragmented, power-law market.

1,000 startups, but the top 1% capture 48% of all revenue — diligence must find the outliers, not the average.

2

Substance beats social buzz.

Search authority predicts revenue far better than follower counts (r = 0.48 vs 0.18) — screen for durable SEO moats, not viral spikes.

3

B2B monetises harder than B2C.

Business-facing startups post a ~5.7x higher median revenue than consumer-facing ones at the same stage.

4

A marketplace is forming on top of the data.

26% of startups already list for sale at verified multiples — the infrastructure layer itself is an emerging opportunity.

Recommendation: back the top-decile operators with durable search authority and B2B economics — or back the verification and marketplace infrastructure that captures value across the entire long tail.